

A STUDY OF MATTHEW

PREPARE THE WAY OF THE LORD"

Tom D Kat 2014

Lesson 4

Thirty years after Jesus was born, another dramatic figure appeared on the scene;

(Matt 3:1-3)'In those days John the Baptist (In Hebrew; Yochanan the Immerser) came preaching in the wilderness of Judea, and saying, "REPENT, FOR THE KINGDOM OF HEAVEN IS AT HAND!"

Matthew went on to explain:

"for this is he who was spoken of the prophet Isaiah, saying:", "The voice of one crying out in the wilderness: Prepare the way of the Lord; Make straight paths for Him!" (Isaiah 40:3)

EXPECTATION OF THE MESSIAH AT A FEVER PITCH

At that time in Israel, there was much religious stirring going on, expectation of the Messiah was at a fever pitch! Why was that? Because they could count!! Daniel, whose understanding of the "the time of the end" came directly from God, had given them a TIME-LINE! A time line we still, examine, today, to help us understand the "time of the end" that is still future. The Arch-Angel Gabriel appeared to Daniel in response to his intercession on behalf of Israel, and revealed to him; that:

(Dan 9:24-26) Seventy (Shabuim)) Weeks (a common Hebrew expression meaning "weeks of years") has been decreed for you for your people and your Holy City, (Jerusalem) to finish the transgression, for making an end to sin, to make atonement (forgiveness) for bringing in everlasting righteousness or (justice), for setting the seal on vision and prophet, and to anoint the most Holy place." you are to know and discern that seven weeks of years will elapse from, the issuing of a decree to restore and rebuild Jerusalem, until the Messiah the Prince, presents Himself in the Temple, as King! Then after 62 weeks (it the city) will remain built for another 62 weeks. Then after 62 weeks, Meshach,